



Mango brings tons of new features to Windows Phone



phone with Mango checked with the Browsermark benchmarking test is found to be four times as fast as the previous version. Unfortunately, the latest Android 2.3 phones and BlackBerry 7 phones run against these very same benchmarks faster.

Many more screens and apps which previously couldn't, can now switch to the landscape display mode. Multitasking with Mango is surely a blessing. Holding down the phone's Back button lets you switch between the previous five apps used. Currently, only a few apps such as the Google Reader client gReadie, can update data in the background and display it on live tiles.

Many games as usual connect to Xbox Live, letting you add gamer points and achievements to your list. Windows Phone is still possibly one of the best mobile OSes for gaming. In terms of inbuilt apps, both the email and office apps have been upgraded. Merging multiple mailboxes and calendars into one view is now possible. You can also set up individual folders into different home screen tiles. There's a new conversation view in email, and you can more easily start calendar entries by typing directly into a calendar line.

The Office Hub can now automatically connect to your SkyDrive, letting you back up and get files onto your phone with ease. Bing Vision, a clone of Google Goggles, lets you search for objects by scanning barcodes to return web and shopping results, or translating text between languages. Mango comes with a new, flashier voice-to-text feature. Text messages can be dictated using voice commands, and voice input is via a bluetooth headset.